

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
AGENCIES, SYSTEMS, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL
FILING OR CYBERSECURITY GUIDE**

Civil Appeal Docketing Statement

Filed: February 18, 2026 **Synthetic docket:** SYN-CA4-26-CV-4106 **Appellant:** Open Grid Archive

Open Grid Archive submits this civil appeal docketing statement through fictional counsel Tamsin Roe and Leo Marr. The appellee is the United States Department of Energy, represented in the exercise by Corin Pell. The originating action bears synthetic docket SYN-DMD-25-CV-0914 and was assigned to fictional District Judge Sable Hart.

The action arose under the Freedom of Information Act. Open Grid challenged DOE's withholding and segregation decisions concerning a closed collection of fictional Grid Sentinel records and also challenged restrictions placed on judicial filings used to adjudicate those decisions. The parties did not litigate a live incident, a real system, or the adequacy of any operational security practice.

The district court entered a memorandum opinion and final judgment on January 2, 2026. It upheld DOE's use of Exemptions 7(E) and 7(F), accepted DOE's segregability showing, and maintained broad restrictions over controlled filings. Open Grid filed a notice of appeal on February 2. The district clerk transmitted the certified index on February 9.

This statement identifies the procedural posture and anticipated issues. It does not amend the notice of appeal, replace a merits brief, or concede that every asserted withholding or access restriction was properly supported.

Appellate Jurisdiction

The district court's January 2 judgment resolved the claims of all parties and ended the civil action except for implementation of the relief denied or granted by that judgment. Open Grid invokes appellate jurisdiction under 28 U.S.C. § 1291. No claim, counterclaim, or party remained awaiting adjudication when the notice of appeal was filed.

The February 2 notice identifies both the final judgment and the district court's sealing determination that merged into the completed action. Open Grid therefore expects to seek review of the exemption and segregability rulings as well as the access restrictions applied to materials used in deciding the cross-motions. The appeal does not arise from a freestanding discovery dispute or an unfinished administrative remand.

The district docket reflects entry of judgment by fictional clerk Teren Wye on the same day as the memorandum opinion. The certified record includes the notice of appeal and the order transmitting the indexed materials. There is no pending motion identified as altering the finality of the judgment or the date on which appellate review began.

Open Grid's jurisdictional position is limited to this synthetic record. The statement does not propose that every sealing order is immediately appealable in a different posture. It asserts only that review is available here from the district court's completed final decision and from rulings incorporated into that disposition.

Nature of the Case and Disposition Below

Nila Quen submitted request DOE-FOIA-2024-OG-041 for final and superseded editions of fictional cyber-response playbooks and related governance instruments. After clarification under ACK-OG-0610 and CLR-OG-0621, the search excluded drafts, routine correspondence, actual incident material, technical configuration data, credentials, and personal contact information. DOE later identified twelve responsive records comprising 200 source pages.

Initial decision RLS-OG-001 produced 146 page images and withheld fifty-four pages completely. Administrative appeal DOE-APR-2024-OG-017 ended with final agency decision FAD-OG-1007, which affirmed the asserted exemption and segregation determinations. During the district litigation, supplemental production RLS-OG-002 disclosed seventeen additional passages on eleven replacement pages without locating another responsive record.

The parties filed cross-motions supported by declarations, public redacted materials, and controlled counterparts using invented labels. The district court accepted a law-enforcement purpose, sustained the claimed 7(E) and 7(F) categories, found the remaining information nonsegregable, and continued broad sealing. Final judgment was entered for DOE.

Open Grid does not appeal the reported search locations or the conclusion that the responsive universe contains twelve records. It seeks review of whether the asserted exemptions and access restrictions were justified at the required level of specificity.

Questions Expected on Appeal

The first question is whether nonpublic trigger relationships, ordering relationships, and implementation details within the operational decision tree fall within Exemption 7(E), while surrounding general or administrative text remains subject to ordinary disclosure analysis. Open Grid recognizes that a properly supported operational detail may be withheld and contests the broader treatment of neutral material.

The second question concerns DOE's categorical Exemption 7(F) presentation. The appeal will ask whether the public Vaughn descriptions and controlled submissions connect meaningful functional groups of information to a reasonable expected danger to life or physical safety, rather than relying on a safety-themed label alone.

The third question is segregability. Open Grid contends that DOE did not adequately demonstrate a page-level determination for headings, approval history, revision language, and general coordination prose, particularly after the agency released seventeen additional passages during litigation.

The fourth question concerns access to judicial records. Open Grid will argue that the district court's broad sealing order lacked the material-specific findings, consideration of alternatives, and narrow tailoring required by the governing access framework. It does not oppose temporary protection for genuinely controlled details when a public counterpart and a particularized justification exist.

These questions describe the anticipated briefing. They do not introduce an alternative factual record, a later-created agency showing, or any hypothetical branch of this appeal.

Parties, Record, and Related Proceedings

Open Grid Archive is a fictional Maryland nonprofit that describes itself as a publisher of public-record explanations. DOE is the federal institutional respondent. No parent corporation, publicly traded owner, insurer, intervenor, or additional party is identified in the district record. The individual names appearing in the file are fictional exercise participants, not parties in their personal capacities.

The certified record encompasses the agency request chain, search and processing declarations, primary and supplemental Vaughn materials, paired public and controlled samples, cross-motions, the access motion and certificate, the district court's orders, judgment, docket report, and transmittal. The litigation copies do not change the agency arithmetic. Decision-tree records total sixty pages, escalation matrices fifty-four, coordination appendices sixty-four, and governance instruments twenty-two.

Open Grid is aware of no related appeal, earlier appellate disposition, bankruptcy, consolidated action, or parallel state case involving these fictional parties and the same judgment. The administrative appeal concluded before suit and is part of the record rather than a separately pending proceeding.

Some filings contain public and controlled counterparts. Their semantic alignment exists so the court may discuss a common subject without exposing a restricted asset. This statement cites no hidden field and confers no access. Any later viewing condition must be established by a document-specific order under the appellate sealing procedure.

Requested Treatment and Certification

Open Grid anticipates requesting partial affirmance, partial vacatur, and remand. It expects to acknowledge protection for adequately supported nonpublic operational decision-tree details under 7(E), while seeking renewed review of categorical 7(F), segregability, and the breadth of district-court sealing. The precise requested disposition will be developed in the opening brief.

The parties have been directed to file public counterparts for any controlled appellate briefs or appendix excerpts. Open Grid will submit a separate public motion and certificate identifying the documents for which temporary restricted treatment is sought. The filing of this docketing statement does not itself restrict access to anything and does not identify a controlled value.

Counsel certify that the statement uses only facts present in the closed synthetic record as of February 18, 2026. It does not rely on a later agency correction, a later opinion, or material outside this record. The numerical account remains sixteen thousand eight hundred forty-two raw hits, 1,284 deduplicated candidates, forty-six custodian-reviewed files, and twelve responsive records totaling 200 pages.

Tamsin Roe and Leo Marr certify service on Corin Pell through the fictional appellate docket. No service address or authentic credential is included. Counsel will promptly notify the Clerk of a change affecting the parties, finality, related-case response, or requested public-access treatment.